HARIAKSHA GUNDA

Curriculum Vitae

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EDUCATION

The University of Alabama — Tuscaloosa, AL
B.S. in Data Science — 08/2022 – 05/2027

- Minors: Mathematics, Computer Science, Economics
- Relevant Coursework: Development Economics, Non-Linear Optimization Theory, Real Analysis I-II, Machine Learning, Database Management Systems
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

The University of Alabama — Tuscaloosa, AL
B.A. in Foreign Languages and Literature — 08/2022 – 05/2027

- Concentration: German Language and Literature
- Minors: International Studies, Public Policy Studies, Global and Cultural Perspectives
- Relevant Coursework: Issues in Global Governance, Environmental Decision-Making, International Social Work, American Public Policy
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, UA Culverhouse College of Business — 01/2024 – Present
Research Assistant, The University of Chicago — 06/2026 – 07/2026
Visiting Researcher, Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy — 05/2025 - 08/2025
Data Scientist, Planet Indonesia International — 12/2024 - 04/2025
Research Assistant, UA Digital Forensics and Cyber Security Lab — 08/2023 - 12/2023
Data Scientist, Alabama Department of Public Health Center for Health Statistics — 05/2023 - 06/2023

HONORS AND AWARDS

Ambassador, Institute for Economics and Peace — 04/2026 – Present
Scholarship (7x, applied each semester), Zeta Psi Educational Foundation — 01/2023 – 03/2026
REAL List: Global and Intercultural Learning Top 25, The University of Alabama — 12/2025
Microsoft Emerging Leader, Microsoft Security — 04/2025 – Present
Gilman Scholars Brussels EU Study Tour Selection, US Department of State — 06/2025
National Award for Undergraduates of German, German National Honor Society — 04/2025
Gilman Research Scholarship, US Department of State — 12/2024 - 08/2025
Boren Scholarship, US Department of Defense — 04/2024 - 04/2025
Outstanding Cultural Organization, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club) — 04/2024
Critical Language Scholarship, US Department of State (declined) — 03/2024
Excellence Second-Year, University of Alabama German Department — 04/2023
Best Event Award, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club Mock Shaadi) — 04/2023
Children of Associates Premier Scholarship (3x), H&R Block — 09/2022 – 09/2023
Crimson Scholar, The University of Alabama — 08/2022 – 05/2024
National Merit Finalist Scholarship, National Merit Scholarship Corporation — 04/2022

PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations

World Congress on Undergraduate Research (WorldCUR), Zayed University, Dubai, United Arab Emirates (accepted). January 2027. *Smoke and Strife: Wind-Instrumented Fire Exposure and Social Conflict in Indonesia*

Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy Brown Bag Seminar. August 2025. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

Planet Indonesia International Intern Symposium. April 2025. *Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces using Data on Ecology and Socio-economic and Environmental Resilience*

State University of Malang Student Seminars. December 2024. *Assessment of Marine Environmental Risks in Indonesia*

Poster Presentations

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Heat Is On: Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Conflict Probability and Intensity in Indonesia*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. March 2024. *The Impact of Linguistic Features on Revenues using NLP on Mission Statements of Tax-Exempt Organizations*

POLICY PAPERS

"ACCOUNTING FOR AIR: Uncertainty Disclosure and Community Monitoring to Correct Geographic Power Imbalances in AI Air Quality Estimates"

Entente Cordiale Day Challenge (working paper). Co-authored by Hariaksha Gunda, Nick Van Deventer, and Samuel Miller. Advised by Dr. Xinyue Ye. Expected January 2027.

CERTIFICATIONS AND SPECIAL LEARNING

Documenting Development Data Using Metadata Standards, The World Bank Group 08/2026
Responsible AI in a Global Context, United Nations University 07/2026
How Tech Drives Sustainability, LinkedIn Learning 06/2026
IEP Ambassador Seminars, Institute for Economics and Peace 05/2026
Positive Peace Academy, Institute for Economics and Peace 02/2026
Microsoft Emerging Leader Professional Development Series, Microsoft Security 08/2025
Climate Catalysts Mentorship Program, UNFCCC 05/2025
Becoming a Climate Champion, UNITAR 04/2025
Digital4Sustainability Learning Path, UNSSC 03/2025
Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification, DeepLearning.AI 02/2025
AI For Everyone, DeepLearning.AI 01/2024
Cybersecurity Foundations Specialization, InfoSEC 05/2023
Python Essential Training, LinkedIn Learning 11/2022

PROJECTS

The University of Alabama 01/2026 – Present
Principal Investigator *Working Paper*

- Smoke and Strife: Fire Exposure and Social Conflict in Indonesia

The University of Chicago, The University of Alabama, The University of Toronto 10/2025 – Present
Research Assistant to Dr. John List, Dr. Michael Price, and Dr. Angela Doku *Working Paper*

- Reading the Storm: Media Attribution of United States Climate Disasters, A Long Panel

The University of Alabama 01/2024 – 05/2024
Research Assistant to Dr. Michael Price *No longer active*

- Impact of Mission Statement Linguistic Features on Nonprofit Revenues

ZEW Mannheim, The University of Alabama 05/2025 – 08/2025
Research Assistant to Dr. Martin Kesternich and Dr. Michael Price *No longer active*

- The Effects of GDPR on Firm Behavior and Innovation

Planet Indonesia International 12/2024 – 04/2025
Data Scientist with Adam Miller *Completed*

- Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces

EXTRACURRICULARS AND AFFILIATIONS

Research Ambassador, UA Office of Undergraduate Research 04/2026 – 05/2027
Member, Blue Key Honor Society 04/2026 – Present
Member, Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society 04/2026 – Present
Member, Pi Mu Epsilon, the National Honor Society for Mathematics 04/2026 – Present
Member, UA Philomathic Literary Society 03/2026 – 05/2027
Member, UA Education Abroad Alumni Association 03/2026 – Present
President, United Nations Association of the USA at UA 08/2025 – 05/2026
Technology Mechanisms Working Group Member, UNFCCC YOUNGO 06/2025 – Present
Member, United Nations Association of the USA 06/2025 – 06/2026
Member, Asian Environmental Youth Network 06/2025 – Present
Data Volunteer, Oxford Net Zero Tracker 05/2025 – Present
Member, Delta Phi Alpha (German National Honor Society) 05/2024 – Present
Member, National Security Education Program (NSEP) Alumni Association 05/2024 – Present
Honors College Ambassador, UA Honors College 03/2024 – 05/2027
Scholarship Officer, Zeta Psi International Fraternity 01/2023 – 05/2027
Member, Golden Key Honor Society 09/2022 – Present
Secretary & Advisor, UA South Asian Culture Club 08/2022 – 05/2027
Member, Association for Computing Machinery 08/2022 – Present
Member, Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers 08/2022 – Present
Member, UA German Club 08/2022 – 05/2027
Choreographer, Teacher, Dancer, Nach Basanti (Indian fusion dance team) 08/2022 – 05/2027

FEATURED

Podcasts

Put the Guidebook Down. April 2026. *Speaking the Place: How Language Changes the Way You Travel*

Put the Guidebook Down. December 2025. *The Power of a Gap Year: Breaking Out of the Linear Life Path*

Datasets

Oxford Net Zero Tracker. September 2025. *Net Zero Stocktake 2025*

SKILLS

Technical Skills: Python, Econometrics, Field Experiments, R, SQL, MATLAB, TensorFlow, Webscraping, Database Management, Git, HTML/CSS/JS, LaTeX, Stata, QGIS

Languages: *German* (CEFR B1: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Indonesian* (ACTFL 2: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Malay* (Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Telugu* (Basic)